



YOU DON'T CHOOSE THE PERSON YOU LOVE BUT YOU CERTAINLY CAN CHOOSE THE GADGET THAT YOU WANT TO BUY AND EVEN SAVE MONEY ALONG THE WAY.

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Raise your hand if you've ever found yourself frantically skimming through hundreds of websites at the eleventh hour trying to find a gift for a special someone. With Valentine's Day right around the corner, we're certain that quite a few of us are going to be in this exact predicament. Shopping for someone else can be quite a task since you need this gift to be special. That means you should know their interests, their favourite pastimes, whether they already own a lot of the things you're planning to buy, and a lot more.

On the other hand, buying for yourself is way easier. You know exactly what you want to buy. Either you know before you make the purchase, or a little thing called 'buyer's remorse' is going to rear its ugly head right after you've bought something to let you know that you've plunked down your hard-earned money for something that is totally not worth your time.

Either way, you're going to be staring at some e-commerce portal over the next couple of days figuring out what to buy or you'll be doing that

every month in repentance if you buy something stupid for your certain someone. While we do have recommendations in the stories that follow this one about things that you could purchase, what we'd like to start off with is a nice guide to saving some money while you go about buying gifts. Whether you're dropping the L-word or are getting engaged or are already married to someone special, we're sure that at least one of the following steps will certainly help you save some money in your gift buying journey.

PUT ALL YOUR CARDS ON THE TABLE

We're not talking about "Sorry I missed our Valentine's Day" cards. If you're one of those people, then you should already know that a simple card isn't going to make the cut and we wish you the best of luck in salvaging this massive screw up. We're talking about plastic money i.e. Debit Cards and Credit Cards.

Practically every bank has arrived at some tie-up with several e-commerce platforms in India to provide great discounts and offers to gain higher points when you shop online.

The big banks such as SBI, ICICI, KOTAK, HDFC, etc. are seen to be featured most often on the big shopping festivals on these e-commerce portals. For times when there are no shopping festivals, you'll still see at least one major bank offering some sort of cashback or another method to save some moolah.



Then there are the cards that were designed to have persistent benefits. These are usually co-branded cards. Such as the Amazon ICICI Credit card which not only has a pretty high limit but the amount of cashback you get with each item you shop on Amazon's many services offset your total expenditure. These co-branded cards usually have no minimum threshold for the benefits to kick in, so even if you were buying groceries on, let's say Amazon, then the Amazon ICICI